

FREE BONUS

Pressure Canning
Starter Checklist Pack

Two printable guides that take the guesswork out of your first sesión

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WHAT'S INSIDE

CHECKLIST 1

Equipment & Safety Check

Everything to check before your first session — and before every season. Equipment inventory and canner safety inspection.

CHECKLIST 2

Session Guide

The complete session from preparation to seal check — every step in order with headspace and processing time tables built in.

Both checklists are printable. Keep them in the kitchen while you work.

CHECKLIST 1 — Equipment & Safety Check

Check this before your first session of the season — and after any equipment drop, damage, or long storage period. Replace anything that fails inspection before canning.

A — EQUIPMENT INVENTORY

- ☐ Pressure canner
- ☐ Canning rack (inside canner)
- ☐ Mason-type jars — wide mouth recommended
- ☐ New flat lids — single use only
- ☐ Screw bands / rings
- ☐ Jar lifter
- ☐ Canning funnel
- ☐ Bubble remover / headspace tool
- ☐ Kitchen timer
- ☐ Permanent marker and labels
- ☐ Clean damp cloths for rim wiping
- ☐ Ladle and large pot for broth

⚠ Never use commercial jars (pasta sauce, mayonnaise) for pressure canning. Mason-type jars only. Inspect every rim — discard any jar with a chip, crack, or rough spot.

B — CANNER SAFETY CHECK (before every season)

ALL CANNERS

- ☐ Vent port — hold to light and look through. Clear?
- ☐ Gasket — no cracks, dryness, or deformation
- ☐ Safety fuse or overpressure plug — intact
- ☐ Canner rack — in place and undamaged

DIAL-GAUGE ONLY

- ☐ Gauge tested for accuracy this season
- ☐ Reads within 2 PSI at 5, 10, and 15 PSI marks

CHECKLIST 2 — Session Guide

Follow in order. Do not skip steps. Keep this open on the counter while you work. Steps correspond to the 7-Step Workflow in Chapter 2 of the book.

THE NIGHT BEFORE

- ☐ Check jar inventory — enough for the full batch?
- ☐ Thaw frozen meat in the refrigerator overnight
- ☐ Soak dried beans or dried corn if the recipe requires it
- ☐ Measure and prepare all seasonings
- ☐ Confirm you have enough canning salt, new lids, and broth or water

THE MORNING OF — BEFORE YOU START

- ☐ Clear and clean counter space next to stove
- ☐ Set out all tools: jar lifter, funnel, bubble remover, headspace tool, timer, cloths
- ☐ Wash canner, rack, and all tools with hot soapy water
- ☐ Place rack inside canner and add 2–3 inches of hot water
- ☐ Wash jars in hot soapy water and inspect every rim — discard any with chips or cracks
- ☐ Keep jars hot until ready to fill — pot of simmering water or dishwasher heated dry cycle

STEP 1 — PREPARE YOUR WORKSPACE AND EQUIPMENT

- ☐ Workspace clear and clean — everything in reach before meat comes out
- ☐ All tools set out and ready
- ☐ Canner water hot (~180°F)
- ☐ Jars hot and ready to fill
- ☐ Recipe open — processing time and pressure confirmed in Appendix A

STEP 2 — PREPARE YOUR MEAT

- ☐ Trim visible fat to under ¼ inch
- ☐ Brown or simmer meat until rare — not fully cooked through
- ☐ Bring canning liquid to a boil
- ☐ All seasonings measured and ready before filling begins

STEP 3 — FILL THE JARS

- ☐ Canning funnel in jar opening
- ☐ Pack meat loosely — do not compress
- ☐ Add hot liquid to cover meat

- ☐ Add salt and seasonings as specified in recipe
- ☐ Run bubble remover around inside edge of jar — remove all air pockets

HEADSPACE — confirm before wiping rim:

Protein	Headspace
Beef, pork, venison, ground meat	**1 inch (2.5 cm)**
Chicken, turkey, rabbit — boneless or bone-in	**1¼ inches (3 cm)**

- ☐ Wipe jar rim with clean damp cloth — one thorough pass — non-negotiable
- ☐ Place lid centered on rim, gasket side down
- ☐ Apply band fingertip-tight — firm, not cranked down

LAST CHECK BEFORE LOADING THE CANNER

- ☐ Correct headspace on every jar
- ☐ No air bubbles visible
- ☐ Jar rim clean and dry
- ☐ Lid centered and band fingertip-tight
- ☐ All jars upright and ready

STEP 4 — LOAD THE CANNER AND VENT

- ☐ Place jars on rack using jar lifter — keep upright at all times
- ☐ Lock canner lid securely
- ☐ Leave vent port open — do not place weight yet
- ☐ Heat on high until steady, continuous steam flows from vent port
- ☐ Set timer: vent for 10 full minutes without interruption

STEP 5 — PRESSURIZE AND PROCESS

- ☐ After 10 minutes venting: place weighted gauge or close petcock
- ☐ Wait for canner to reach correct pressure (3–10 minutes)
  Dial-gauge: watch needle reach correct PSI
  Weighted-gauge: weight begins to rock or jiggle steadily
- ☐ Start processing timer when correct pressure is reached
- ☐ Adjust heat to maintain steady pressure — avoid large swings

PROCESSING TIMES — confirm in Appendix A for your canner type and altitude:

Protein	Pack	Pints	Quarts	Note
Beef, pork, venison — strips/cubes	Hot/Raw	75 min	90 min	—
Ground / chopped meat	Hot only	75 min	90 min	—
Chicken / rabbit — boneless	Hot/Raw	75 min	90 min	—
Chicken / rabbit — bone-in	Hot/Raw	65 min	75 min	—
Beans + meat (Chile Con Carne)	Hot only	75 min	**PINTS ONLY**	—

⚠️ If pressure drops at any point: bring back to pressure and restart timer from zero. Partial processing is not safe processing.

STEP 6 — COOL NATURALLY

- ☐ Turn off heat when processing time is complete
- ☐ Do NOT force-cool — no cold water, no fan, no early venting
- ☐ Let canner depressurize naturally: ~30 min pints / ~45 min quarts
- ☐ Confirm full depressurization: dial-gauge reads zero / vent lock drops
- ☐ Remove weighted gauge or open petcock — wait 10 more minutes
- ☐ Open lid tilting away from you
- ☐ Remove jars with jar lifter — keep upright, do not tilt
- ☐ Place on towel or rack with 1 inch space between jars
- ☐ Do not retighten bands, press lids, or move jars
- ☐ Let cool undisturbed 12–24 hours

STEP 7 — CHECK SEALS (12–24 hours after processing)

- ☐ Remove screw bands

Press test	Tap test	Visual test
Lid is concave and does not flex when pressed	Clear, high-pitched ring when tapped with a spoon	Lid curves slightly downward at center

✅ **If sealed:**

- ☐ Wash outside of jar
- ☐ Label: contents + date + altitude if above 1,000 ft
- ☐ Store upright, 50–70°F, away from light and heat
- ☐ Newest jars to the back — FIFO

❌ **If not sealed:**

- ☐ Refrigerate and use within 3–4 days
- ☐ OR reprocess within 24 hours with a new lid using the full original processing time